

Kokusai Electric (6525.T): Conf. call: Near-term orders strong on brisk memory capex; China demand likely to remain firm in next few years

After the close on August 17, we hosted a conference call for investors with Kokusai Electric President and CEO Kazunori Tsukada as the main speaker. The main points are summarized below, focusing on 1Q (April-June) order trends, the background to the upward revision of FY3/27 guidance, and the outlook for FY3/27-FY3/28 earnings, including production capacity and procurement. Orders are expanding on the back of customers' strong capex appetite, especially for memory, and we see near-term upside. We expect earnings growth to slightly beat the market consensus in FY3/27-FY3/28, but we maintain our Neutral rating as the stock does not look considerably undervalued compared to other SPE makers.

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Breakdown of 1Q earnings and orders

1Q (April-June) sales were largely in line with initial guidance (beating by c.¥5 bn), while orders came to ¥140 bn, well above the company's expectations. The breakdown of orders is ¥116 bn for equipment and ¥22 bn for services, with c.¥1 bn for forex impact. Looking at equipment orders by application, NAND came to ¥36 bn (of which c.40% was outside China), DRAM ¥58 bn (c.60%), logic/foundry ¥19 bn (c.70%), and others ¥4 bn (c.25%), with orders for NAND applications and from Chinese DRAM customers beating guidance. Kokusai Electric expects orders in 2Q to be on par with 1Q levels. Although the company currently guides for orders to decline in 2H compared to 1H, it said there could be fluctuations depending on the progress of customers' investment plans, as equipment orders from customers outside China in particular tend to be placed at a timing closer to shipment.

Details of the FY3/27 guidance revision

Regarding the **sales outlook to regions worldwide**, NAND was raised from ¥34 bn to ¥46 bn, DRAM from ¥80 bn to ¥82 bn, and logic/foundry from ¥40 bn to ¥49 bn (others left unchanged at ¥7 bn). The increase in NAND was mainly driven by investment at Chinese bases by South Korean manufacturers and upward revisions to investment plans at Singapore bases by US manufacturers; DRAM was increased due to higher visibility on investment plans at South Korean bases by South Korean manufacturers; and logic/foundry was increased primarily on the back of rising demand related to advanced packaging at Taiwanese foundries. The outlook on **sales to local Chinese customers** was also revised upward across all applications, with NAND raised from ¥11 bn to ¥18 bn, DRAM from ¥20 bn to ¥35 bn, logic/foundry from ¥30 bn to ¥34 bn, and others from ¥7 bn to ¥9 bn. The main

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factors were accelerating equipment installations at the largest Chinese NAND manufacturer, and the likelihood of equipment installation plans being raised for the new Shanghai fab of the largest Chinese DRAM manufacturer. In logic/foundry, in addition to continuous and robust investment by two majors, the company noted strength among non-majors as well, including investment for mature nodes. Kokusai said it sees potential for sales to local Chinese customers to expand over the next several years, given ongoing strong capex appetite among customers.

FY3/27-FY3/28 earnings outlook

Regarding sales for 2H3/27, Kokusai said major upside is unlikely for equipment sales from a lead time perspective, but noted scope for a beat in service-related sales (especially parts). Regarding production capacity amid expectations for further sales growth heading into FY3/28, the company's policy is to first maximize utilization at existing cleanrooms by increasing shifts as necessary (workers are currently on one shift plus overtime), and it noted that it has secured upward flexibility for the time being as the Tonami plant has space that can be converted into manufacturing areas. As for parts procurement, Kokusai Electric recognizes that raising the capacity of partner companies is equally important, and noted that it is working to improve the capacity of the entire supply chain on the procurement front by providing longer-term procurement plans to partners (it said at present, there are no rate-limiting factors in procurement that would create production bottlenecks). In response to rising material costs, management said it is pushing forward with passing costs onto product prices and that it has had a certain degree of success, and aims for pricing that better reflects the added value of the products going forward.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Kokusai Electric

Valuation methodology: Our 12-month target price of ¥10,000 is based on our FY3/28E estimates and an EV/EBITDA multiple of 18X, the global SPE sector average (our TP implies FY3/28E P/E of 27X and P/B of 7.1). Our rating is Neutral.

Key risks: Trends in investment at key customers, additional changes in export controls, and changes in the competitive landscape due to strategic changes at competitors.

6525.T	12m Price Target: ¥10,000	Price: ¥9,306	Upside: 7.5%
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Neutral	GS Forecast				
Market cap: ¥2.2tr / \$13.6bn Enterprise value: ¥2.2tr / \$13.7bn 3m ADTV: ¥71.8bn / \$447.0mn Japan Japan Semiconductor, SPE & Precision M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (¥ bn)	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
	Op. profit (¥ bn)	235.1	342.2	433.7	483.0
	Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	41.8	83.0	116.9	134.2
	EPS (¥)	–	79.4	–	–
	P/E (X)	128.8	259.0	365.3	419.8
	P/B (X)	32.6	35.9	25.5	22.2
	Dividend yield (%)	4.5	8.3	6.6	5.4
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	0.9	0.7	1.0	1.2
	CROCI (%)	(0.1)	0.1	(0.2)	(0.5)
		22.3	31.7	34.7	35.2
		6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
	EPS (¥)	49.6	63.5	67.4	78.4

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 17 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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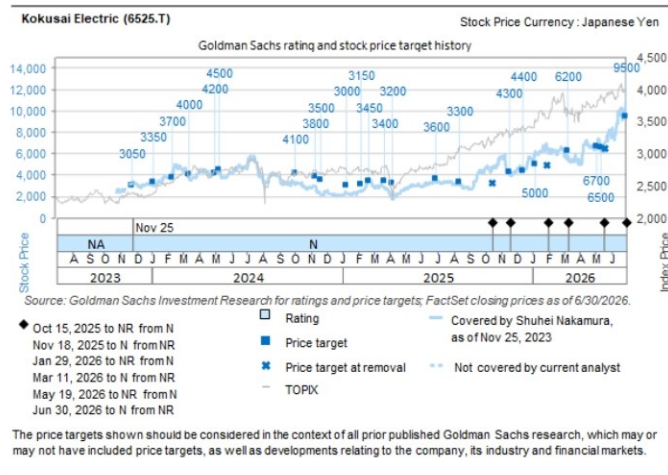
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Kokusai Electric (6525.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
06-Aug-26	10,000	8,224
30-Jun-26	9,500	10,855
13-May-26	6,500	6,170
04-May-26	6,700	6,500
11-Mar-26	6,200	5,768
06-Jan-26	5,000	5,812
15-Dec-25	4,400	4,516
18-Nov-25	4,300	4,033
15-Aug-25	3,300	3,066
30-Jun-25	3,600	3,467
07-Apr-25	3,200	1,790
24-Mar-25	3,400	2,803
21-Feb-25	3,450	3,629
07-Feb-25	3,150	2,518
10-Jan-25	3,000	2,242
21-Nov-24	3,500	2,195
11-Nov-24	3,800	2,953
02-Oct-24	4,100	3,130
10-May-24	4,500	4,275
02-May-24	4,200	4,105
13-Mar-24	4,000	3,770
09-Feb-24	3,700	4,100
04-Jan-24	3,350	2,983
25-Nov-23	3,050	3,220

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